

Word family: **remark / remarks / remarked / remarking / remarkable / remarkably / unremarkable**

Base word: remark

Past tense: remarked

Past participle: remarked

** -ing form:** remarking

Related forms: remarkable, remarkably, unremarkable

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “He can move from a serious topic to a witty **remark** in a heartbeat...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **remark** means a **short spoken comment or observation about something**.

A **witty remark** is therefore a short comment that is clever and amusing.

繁體中文： ** **針對某件事情說出的一句較短評論、意見或觀察性說話**

中文翻譯：

> “He can move from a serious topic to a witty **remark** in a heartbeat...”

「他可以在一瞬間由嚴肅話題轉到一句機智幽默的**評論 / 話語**。」

Here:

witty remark = 一句簡短而機智幽默的評論或說話

1. **remark = comment/statement (說話 / 評論) — 評語 ; 評論 ; 一句話**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A short comment, statement, or observation that someone makes about something.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He can move from a serious topic to a witty **remark** in a heartbeat.”

「他可以在一瞬間由嚴肅話題轉到一句機智的**評論 / 話語**。」

Practice 2

> “She made an interesting **remark** about the changing neighbourhood.”

「她對這個正在改變的社區說了一句很有意思的**評論**。」

Practice 3

> “His final **remark** made everyone laugh.”

「他最後那句**話 / 評論**令所有人都笑了。」

remark = 某人針對某件事情說出的一句簡短評論、意見或觀察

Common:

- * witty remark
- * casual remark
- * rude remark
- * interesting remark
- * make a remark
- * opening remarks
- * closing remarks

These do not need separate lexical meanings merely because the tone or setting changes.

2. **remarks** = comments made as part of a speech/address (發言 / 致詞) — 講話 ; 發言

In the plural, **remarks** often refers to what someone says publicly, especially in a speech, meeting, ceremony, or formal setting.

Practice 4

> “The director began with a few brief **remarks**.”

「主管先作了幾句簡短的**開場發言**。」

Practice 5

> “Her closing **remarks** thanked everyone for their support.”

「她在**結語 / 總結發言**中感謝大家的支持。」

remarks = 在會議、演說、典禮等場合中說出的一段評論或發言

For database counting, I would **merge this with Meaning 1**.

The underlying semantic idea is still:

> **spoken comments or statements**

The plural and formal context change the natural Chinese translation, but not the core English meaning. That follows the Golden Manual's instruction not to split meanings solely because the context changes.

3. **remark that... / remark + quotation (動詞) — 評論說 ; 說道**

As a verb, **remark** means to say something as a comment or observation.

Practice 6

> “She **remarked** that the city had changed dramatically.”

「她**評論說 / 提到**這座城市已經有很大變化。」

Practice 7

> “‘That’s unusual,’ he **remarked**.”

「『那很不尋常。』他**評論道 / 說道**。」

remark = 針對某件事情作出評論、觀察或簡短說明

This is the verb counterpart of the noun **remark**.

4. **remark on/upon + subject (話題 / 事情) — 評論 ; 談及**

Another common verb pattern is:

> **remark on/upon something**

Practice 8

> “Several guests **remarked on** the unusual design.”

「幾位客人都**評論 / 提到**這個不尋常的設計。」

Practice 9

> “He **remarked upon** how quiet the room had become.”

「他**提到 / 評論了**房間變得多麼安靜。」

remark on/upon something = 就某件事情作出評論、觀察或說明

For database counting, this should be **merged with Meaning 3**.

The preposition changes the grammatical pattern, but not the underlying semantic concept.

Related form: **remarkable**

Remarkable does **not** simply mean “full of remarks.”

It has developed into an adjective meaning:

> **unusual or impressive enough to deserve attention**

Practice 10

> “She made a **remarkable** recovery.”

「她的康復情況非常**驚人 / 非凡**。」

Practice 11

> “He has a **remarkable** memory for small details.”

「他對細節有非常**出色 / 非凡的記憶力**。」

remarkable = 因為非常不尋常、出色或令人驚訝，而特別值得注意的

This is a highly useful family extension.

Related form: **remarkably**

Remarkably means in a way or to a degree that is surprising, unusual, or noteworthy.

Practice 12

> “The building is **remarkably** well preserved.”

「這座建築保存得**出乎意料地好 / 非常好**。」

Practice 13

> “She remained **remarkably** calm.”

「她保持得**異常冷靜 / 令人驚訝地冷靜**。」

remarkably = 程度或方式不尋常得值得注意或令人驚訝地

Related form: **unremarkable**

Unremarkable means ordinary and not particularly noticeable, unusual, or impressive.

Practice 14

> “The building looks fairly **unremarkable** from the outside.”

「這座建築從外面看來相當**普通、不太起眼**。」

Practice 15

> “It was an otherwise **unremarkable** day.”

「除此之外，那只是很**平凡、沒有甚麼特別**的一天。」

unremarkable = 沒有特別突出、驚人或值得注意之處的；普通不起眼的

This forms a useful contrast:

remarkable = 值得注意、非凡的

unremarkable = 沒甚麼特別、不起眼的

Important distinction: **remark** vs **comment**

These overlap strongly.

remark

often refers to one relatively short observation or statement.

> “He made a witty remark.”

「他說了一句機智的話。」

comment

is broader and can refer to an opinion, reaction, criticism, or response.

> “She commented on the proposal.”

「她評論了這項建議。」

In many contexts they are interchangeable, but **remark** often feels like:

> **one particular thing someone said**

whereas **comment** can refer more broadly to giving an opinion.

Important distinction: **remark** vs **statement**

remark

usually sounds relatively brief and often spontaneous.

statement

can be more deliberate, formal, or complete.

> “He made a casual remark.”

= 他隨口說了一句。

> “The company issued a statement.”

= 公司發表了一份正式聲明。

So **statement** is not simply a formal synonym for every use of **remark**.

Important distinction: **remark** vs **observation**

remark

focuses on what someone **says**.

observation

can mean a comment based on something noticed or considered.

> “That was an interesting observation.”

= 那是一個很有意思的觀察 / 見解。

A remark can contain an observation, but **remark** is broader.

Important distinction: **remarkable vs noticeable**

remarkable

means sufficiently unusual, impressive, or extraordinary to deserve attention.

noticeable

simply means easy enough to notice.

> “There was a noticeable change in his voice.”

= 他的聲線有明顯變化。

That change is not necessarily:

> remarkable

or extraordinary.

Important distinction: **remarkable vs impressive**

These overlap, but the emphasis differs.

remarkable

= unusually noteworthy or surprising

****impressive****

= causing admiration

Something can be remarkable without necessarily being admirable.

> “a remarkable coincidence”

is unusual and noteworthy, but not necessarily something to admire.

Historical / rare-use note

Older or more formal English can use ****remark**** in the sense of:

> ****notice / observe****

However, this is not a normal high-value modern learner sense compared with the meanings above.

Under the Golden Manual, archaic, dated, or unusually rare senses should not be promoted into the main polysemy set simply because they exist.

So I would ****exclude that sense from the database's core modern count****.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****remark****

* ****remarks****

* ****remarked****

* ****remarking****

* ****remarkable****

* ****remarkably****

* ****unremarkable****

The most useful contrast is:

****remark = a comment / to comment****

****remarkable = unusual or impressive enough to deserve attention****

****unremarkable = ordinary and not especially noticeable****

Although ****remarkable**** visibly develops from ****remark****, it functions as its own established adjective rather than simply another meaning of the noun or verb.

The Golden Manual says useful family members should be included generously but labelled accurately so that derivatives are not mistaken for additional meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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remark — noun	某人針對某件事情說出的一句簡短評論、意見或觀察性說話
remarks — formal/public comments	在會議、演說或典禮等場合中作出的評論或發言；屬於名詞「評論 / 說話」的同一核心概念
remark — verb	針對某件事情作出簡短評論、觀察或說明
remark on/upon something	就某件事情作出評論或觀察；屬於動詞 remark 的同一核心概念
remarkable	因非常不尋常、出色或令人驚訝，而特別值得注意的
remarkably	以不尋常、令人驚訝或值得注意的程度 / 方式
unremarkable	沒有特別突出、驚人或值得注意之處的；普通、不起眼的

For your original sentence

> “He can move from a serious topic to a witty ****remark**** in a heartbeat.”

The exact meaning is:

****remark = 某人針對某件事說出的一句簡短評論或說話****

More specifically:

****witty remark = 一句短而機智、令人覺得幽默的評論或話語****

So:

> ****a witty remark****

= ****一句機智幽默的評論 / 說話****

For your database, I would count ****2 genuinely useful core polysemy/polyfunctionality entries**** for

remark:

1. **noun** — a short comment, statement, or observation
2. **verb** — to make such a comment or observation

I would **not** split *opening remarks, witty remark, rude remark,* and *remark on something* into separate meanings, because they retain the same basic semantic concept. **Remarkable / remarkably / unremarkable** are useful family extensions, not additional meanings of **remark** itself.